Draft - expert review pending

Note: This unit is complete and passes the platform’s automated checks, but it is not reviewed yet. So, treat its sources and claims with care. You are encouraged to report errors and provide feedback.

Unit 6 assessment

Unit summary

This unit brought the course's practice half to its instrument: the reflective journal. The running idea is that a journal is a specific kind of writing - not a diary, not a plan, not a report - and it needs structure, routine and honesty to survive a term.

- **Topic 6.1** distinguished a reflective journal from a diary (records events), a lesson plan (prepares for teaching), a scheme of work (maps coverage) and an incident report (documents an event). A journal examines experience in order to learn from it.
- **Topic 6.2** gave the structural elements: a consistent format, a regular schedule, a link between entries and a dated, titled record. Journals die from loss of time, purpose or honesty, and each has a remedy.
- **Topic 6.3** showed three levels of journal writing: descriptive (what happened), reflective with assumption (what happened and what I assumed) and reflective with evidence-tested assumption (what happened, what I assumed, whether the evidence supports it, and what changes). The Unit 1 standards apply to your own entries.
- **Topic 6.4** gave prompts for starting and deepening entries, and drew the course together: the logic of Units 1 to 3 and the practice of Units 4 to 6 meet in the journal, because the journal is where you reason about your own teaching.

Three habits should survive this unit. First, the journal is a journal only if it analyses, not just describes. Second, structure and routine matter more than motivation - a short honest entry every week beats a long safe entry every month. Third, the standards from Unit 1 are not for other people's reasoning. They are for yours.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

Choose the single best answer for each question.

1. *(Remember)* A reflective journal is best described as a document that:
    - A) Records teaching events day by day
    - B) Examines teaching experience in order to learn from it
    - C) Prepares the teacher for the next lesson
    - D) Maps curriculum coverage across a term
2. *(Understand)* The difference between a diary and a reflective journal is that:
    - A) A diary is longer than a journal
    - B) A diary records events; a journal analyses them
    - C) A diary is written by hand; a journal is typed
    - D) There is no difference
3. *(Apply)* A trainee writes, "Taught chapter 5. Pupils were noisy. Gave extra work." This is best described as:
    - A) A reflective journal entry at the evidence-tested level
    - B) A diary entry
    - C) A reflective journal entry at the assumption level

- D) A scheme of work

4. *(Remember)* The four structural elements a reflective journal for assessment needs include all of the following EXCEPT:
   - A) A consistent format
   - B) A regular schedule
   - C) A link between entries
   - D) A different model for each entry
5. *(Apply)* A journal has entries every week, all using Gibbs, but each entry is unrelated to the previous one. What is missing?
   - A) A consistent format
   - B) The return arrow (link between entries)
   - C) A regular schedule
   - D) Nothing - the journal is fine
6. *(Understand)* "Loss of honesty" as a failure mode means that the teacher:
   - A) Forgets to write
   - B) Starts writing what the supervisor wants rather than what actually happened
   - C) Uses too many models
   - D) Writes too little
7. *(Apply)* A journal entry reads, "The pupils did not understand. I think it is because the worksheet was too long." This entry is at which level?
   - A) Descriptive
   - B) Reflective with assumption (not tested)
   - C) Reflective with evidence-tested assumption
   - D) Not a journal entry

8. *(Remember)* Which of the following is a deepening prompt?
    - A) "What did I teach today?"
    - B) "What evidence supports what I am saying?"
    - C) "What is tomorrow's lesson?"
    - D) "How many pupils were present?"
9. *(Understand)* The logic of Units 1 to 3 and the practice of Units 4 to 6 meet in the journal because:
    - A) Both halves are in the same course
    - B) The journal is where you reason about your own teaching, using the standards from Unit 1
    - C) The journal is assessed
    - D) Both halves use Gibbs' model
10. *(Apply)* A trainee says, "I will write my journal when something dramatic happens." Using this unit, the best response is:
    - A) That is the right approach
    - B) Most teaching weeks are not dramatic; use a starting prompt instead
    - C) Dramatic events are the only ones worth reflecting on
    - D) Journals should only record successes

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. *(Understand)* In two sentences, state the difference between a reflective journal and a diary.
2. *(Understand)* Name the three reasons journals die and the remedy for one of them.
3. *(Apply)* A trainee writes, "The group work was noisy. I will manage it better next time." Name the level of this entry and say what would

move it to the next level.

4. *(Apply)* A journal uses a different model every week. Using Topic 6.2, explain in two sentences why that is a problem.

5. *(Understand)* Explain in two sentences why a teacher might use a starting prompt when nothing dramatic happened in a week.

6. *(Apply)* A trainee says, "I will write for one hour every Sunday." Using Topic 6.2, give one reason that plan may fail and one way to make it more sustainable.

7. *(Analyze)* A journal entry reads, "The pupils failed the test. I think the test was too hard." Using Topic 6.3, name the level, say what evidence would test the assumption, and rewrite the entry at the evidence-tested level.

8. *(Apply)* Explain in two sentences why "the journal is for the tutor" is a misconception and what the consequence is.

9. *(Understand)* In two sentences, explain how the Unit 1 standards apply to your own journal entries.

10. *(Analyze)* Take this claim: "A journal with twelve descriptive entries is a better journal than one with six reflective entries." Using Topics 6.2 and 6.3, explain what is wrong with this claim.

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. *(Analyze)* Here is a journal entry:

   > "Grade 7, English. Taught essay writing. The pupils could not write an introduction. I helped them. I feel I need to teach introductions better."

   In 150 to 200 words, name the level of this entry, rewrite it at the evidence-tested level with at least one testable hypothesis, and apply

one Unit 1 standard to the original entry.

2. *(Evaluate)* A trainee plans to keep a journal by writing "every day, at least one page, about the best thing that happened." In 200 to 250 words, evaluate this plan against the structural elements and failure modes from Topic 6.2, and rewrite it so it is sustainable and markable.

3. *(Analyze)* Here is a journal entry and the next week's entry from the same trainee:

   > **Week 3:** "The science demonstration failed. I think the apparatus was old. I will ask for new equipment."
   >
   > **Week 4:** "The mathematics lesson went well. I used group work and the pupils were engaged."

   In 200 to 250 words, name the level of each entry, identify the structural problem across the two entries, and rewrite both entries so they are linked and the second is at least at the assumption level.

4. *(Evaluate)* Two trainees submit their assessed reflection files. Trainee A's file has an entry for every teaching day, all descriptive, all positive, all unrelated. Trainee B's file has one entry per week, all using Gibbs, linked by opening sentences, including two entries about lessons that failed. In 200 to 250 words, compare the two files against the marking criteria from Topic 6.2, say which would score higher, and justify your judgement from the content of each file.

5. *(Create)* **Integrative.** In 250 to 300 words, produce one journal entry that (a) uses a course-level prompt from Topic 6.4, (b) draws on at least one idea from Units 1 to 3 and one from Units 4 to 6, (c) reaches the evidence-tested level of reflection (Topic 6.3), and (d) includes the opening sentence that would link it to the previous entry (Topic 6.2).

Answers and marking guidance

This section is for self-study. Work each question before reading it.

MCQ answer key

1. B - a journal examines experience in order to learn; A is a diary, C is a lesson plan, D is a scheme of work.
2. B - the difference is analysis vs recording.
3. B - the entry states what happened with no analysis; it is a diary.
4. D - a journal needs a *consistent* format, not a different model each time.
5. B - the return arrow (link between entries) is missing; without it, the journal is a collection of unrelated entries.
6. B - loss of honesty means writing for the supervisor, not for learning.
7. B - the entry identifies an assumption ("the worksheet was too long") but does not test it against evidence.
8. B - "what evidence supports what I am saying?" is a deepening prompt; A, C and D are descriptive.
9. B - the journal is where you reason about your own teaching, and the standards from Unit 1 keep that reasoning honest.
10. B - most teaching weeks are not dramatic; use a starting prompt to find something worth reflecting on.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. Model: a diary records events in order to remember them. A journal examines teaching experience in order to learn from it. The difference is the presence of analysis. **Marks (2):** 1 - defines a diary; 1 - defines a journal and names the difference.

2. Model: loss of time (remedy: write less but write), loss of purpose (remedy: look back across weeks to see patterns), loss of honesty (remedy: write for yourself first). **Marks (3):** 1 - names all three; 1 - names a remedy for one; 1 - the remedy matches the failure mode.

3. Model: descriptive. It states what happened and forms a resolution. To move to the next level (assumption), it would ask *why* the group work was noisy. To move to evidence-tested, it would ask what evidence supports that hypothesis and what specifically "manage better" means. **Marks (3):** 1 - names the level; 1 - says what the assumption level would add; 1 - says what the evidence-tested level would add.

4. Model: a consistent format is one of the four structural elements. Using a different model every week makes it hard for the marker to see a process, and it makes it hard for the writer to build routine. **Marks (2):** 1 - names the structural element; 1 - explains the consequence.

5. Model: most teaching weeks contain nothing dramatic, so a teacher who waits for an incident worth writing about simply stops writing - the loss-of-time and loss-of-purpose failure modes of Topic 6.2. A starting prompt such as "what surprised me this week?" gives a way into an ordinary week, so the habit survives and the ordinary week still yields something to analyse. **Marks (2):** 1 - says that most weeks are not dramatic, so waiting for an incident ends the writing; 1 - says a prompt provides a way in, with an example or a named prompt.

6. Model: one hour may be unsustainable on a busy week, leading to loss of time. A more sustainable plan: write for 20-30 minutes on a fixed day, and allow short entries (5-8 sentences) on busy weeks. **Marks (2):** 1 - identifies the risk; 1 - proposes a remedy.

7. Model: assumption level (not tested). Evidence that would test it: how many questions did pupils attempt? Did the same pupils who usually perform well also fail? Were the questions from the syllabus or beyond it? Rewrite at evidence-tested level: include the evidence gathered and

a finding. **Marks (4):** 1 - names the level; 1 - names specific evidence that would test it; 1 - a rewrite that includes evidence; 1 - a finding that changes practice.

8. Model: writing for the tutor produces safe, bland entries that show no genuine analysis. The marker rewards honesty and specificity, and can tell the difference between a journal written to learn and one written to impress. **Marks (2):** 1 - states why it is a misconception; 1 - names the consequence.

9. Model: the standards (clarity, accuracy, depth, logic) apply to your own reasoning in a journal entry just as they apply to a staffroom argument. A vague resolution ("I will teach better") fails clarity. An untested assumption ("the pupils were weak") fails accuracy. **Marks (2):** 1 - states that the standards apply to your own writing; 1 - gives an example.

10. Model: the claim rewards quantity over quality. The marking criteria value analysis (Topic 6.3) and development (Topic 6.2) over regularity alone. Six reflective entries that show analysis and learning are worth more than twelve descriptive entries that are merely a diary. **Marks (3):** 1 - identifies the error; 1 - names what the criteria actually reward; 1 - a concrete comparison.

ERQ rubrics

1. Analytic rubric - *Level naming* (0-2: correct with evidence / a general reason / wrong) · *Rewrite to evidence-tested* (0-2: includes a testable hypothesis and evidence / an assumption without testing / stays descriptive) · *Standard applied* (0-2: applies a Unit 1 standard to the original with a specific breach named / a general application / none) · *Clarity* (0-2).

2. Analytic rubric - *Plan evaluation* (0-2: evaluates against at least two structural elements and at least one failure mode / a general evaluation

/ wrong) · *Rewrite* (0-3: a rewritten plan that addresses the problems and names a model, schedule, linking strategy and record format (**Evaluate*: the rewrite turns on the specific content of Topic 6.2) / a partial rewrite / none) · *Sustainability* (0-2: the plan is realistic for a full term / partly realistic / not) · *Clarity* (0-2).

3. Analytic rubric - *Level naming* (0-2: both correctly named / one correct / neither) · *Structural problem identified* (0-2: identifies the missing link between entries / a general problem / none) · *Rewrite* (0-3: both entries rewritten with a link and the second at least at the assumption level (**Analyze*: the rewrite turns on the specific content of the incidents) / a partial rewrite / none) · *Clarity* (0-2).

4. Analytic rubric - *File comparison* (0-2: compares both files against at least three marking criteria / a general comparison / wrong) · *Which scores higher* (0-2: names Trainee B with a reason tied to the criteria / a general reason / wrong) · *Justification* (0-3: justifies from the specific content of each file, showing why analysis and honesty matter more than frequency (**Evaluate*: the comparison turns on the actual content, not on a general preference for quality) / general reasons / a verdict asserted) · *Clarity* (0-2).

5. Analytic rubric - *Course-level prompt used* (0-2: a course-level prompt from Topic 6.4 identified and applied / a general prompt / none) · *Ideas from both halves* (0-2: draws on at least one idea from Units 1-3 and one from Units 4-6 / one half only / neither) · *Evidence-tested level* (0-2: reaches the evidence-tested level with a testable hypothesis / stops at assumption / descriptive) · *Return arrow* (0-2: includes an opening sentence linking to a previous entry / a general sentence / none) · *Clarity* (0-2).

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